

START HERE — The Approval Package

You bought this because getting approved feels like a wall. It isn't — it's a checklist. Every landlord runs the same 5 checks, and every document in this package exists to win one of them. Follow the plan below in order.

What's In Your Package

File	What it does
1 — Renter Resume Template	Your one-page first impression; attach to every inquiry
2 — Reference Sheet	Who to pick, how to prep them, ready-to-send format
3 — Application Checklist & Fee Tracker	Stop burning fees; track everything; spot scams
4 — Explanation Letters	Low credit, past eviction, history gap — the 4-part formula
5 — Cosigner Request Kit	How to ask, what they're agreeing to, alternatives
6 — Landlord Outreach Scripts	The exact messages that get replies and tours
7 — Income Documentation Guide	Prove W-2, gig, cash, benefits & voucher income
8 — What Landlords Actually Check	The 5 screening checks and how to win each one

Your 7-Day Plan

Day 1 — Know your file. Pull your free credit reports (annualcreditreport.com). Note your score range, any collections, and whether an eviction filing will show. Now you know which letters you need.

Day 2 — Build your documents. Renter Resume + Reference Sheet. Text your references (template provided). Start your phone document folder (checklist in File 3).

Day 3 — Prove your income. Follow File 7 for your income type. If you're paid in cash, start the weekly-deposit habit TODAY — it gets stronger every week.

Day 4 — Write your letters. Only the ones for issues that will actually show on screening. Keep each under one page.

Day 5 — Fix the quick stuff. Small utility collections, report errors, credit building setup [MORGAN: links]. Line up your cosigner conversation if you'll need one (File 5).

Day 6–7 — Hunt properly. Check listings 8am & 5pm. Use Script 1 within minutes of a new listing. Track every contact in File 3. Target private landlords if your file has issues (File 8 explains why).

Know Your Philly Rights (60-Second Version)

Philadelphia gives renters more legal protection than almost any city in America. The Renters' Access Act means landlords **MUST** hand you their written screening criteria before taking your

money, CANNOT auto-reject you for a credit score or eviction record alone, CANNOT count evictions 4+ years old or cases they didn't win, and MUST send a written explanation if they deny you — which you have 48 hours to appeal with evidence. Denying you for having a housing voucher is also illegal (source-of-income discrimination). Every guide in this package shows you where to use these rights.

The Three Golden Rules

1. **Speed wins.** Same-hour replies, complete documents, specific tour requests. Most of your competition sends “is this available?” a day late.
2. **Honesty wins.** Get ahead of every issue in writing before they discover it. Never lie — screening sees everything, and one caught lie is an automatic no.
3. **Paper wins.** Approval isn't about being perfect, it's about being PROVABLE. Document everything.

NEED MORE HELP?

[MORGAN: links — credit builder, rent reporting, guarantor service, deposit alternative, voucher guide upsell, your video channel, contact]

The fine print: this package is educational information based on real-world rental experience in Philadelphia. It isn't legal, financial, or credit-repair advice, and no specific outcome is promised — your results depend on your situation and effort. For free legal help with tenant rights: Community Legal Services (clsphila.org) and phillytenant.org. To report discrimination: Philadelphia Commission on Human Relations (phila.gov/phr).